

Genius GHT-S200 5.1 Surround Speakers

The Genius GHT-S200 is a stylish 5.1 surround-sound speaker system targeted at the home entertainment segment. It features a centre speaker for voice, one wooden subwoofer for bass, two rear and two slim front tower speakers.

The speakers consist of four neodymium micro drivers and produce amazingly crisp treble, and the 8-inch subwoofer produces rich, deep bass. However, the speaker system as a whole lacks in the mid-range department. Also, at high volumes—but only at high volumes—the bass begins to distort.

The provided connectors are colour-coded. The speakers can be connected to a DVD player or a 2.1-channel auxiliary source. But for 5.1-channel PC connectivity, you will need to purchase the connecting cables separately.

The Genius GHT-S200 comes with a tiny remote control with just the necessary controls. The subwoofer features an LED display that indicates information such as mode, audio source and volume, which can be

controlled separately for each channel.

The total power output is 200 W RMS. Connect it to your wide-screen TV, and the Genius GHT-S200 will turn your living room into a personal home theatre!

Company **Transtek Infoways Pvt. Ltd.**

Price **Rs 16,500**

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Rating 



Motorola L6

It's Flimsy, But Stylish!

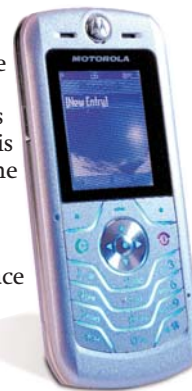
The Motorola L6, a tri-band phone, is the slimmest candybar phone to have hit the shelves. At 11.3 x 4.9 x 1.0 cm, the L6 is slim; however, it's a little too long, and this might hamper its pocketability. Though the body panels are metallic, the L6 feels fragile, and dropping it could prove fatal.

The ergonomics is spot on—the keys have an excellent feel. But the user interface is typical Motorola—unintuitive! Also, the display screen is not as vibrant as those on the latest phones from other manufacturers.

The phone has only a VGA camera, and can shoot video, but the anaemic camera ruins the fun.

Features and the software bundle have taken a backseat to style, but surprisingly, the L6 is Bluetooth-enabled. A mini USB port on the side allows wired data transfer, and also doubles up as the power jack. The L6 has about 10 MB of onboard memory, and there's no memory card support. Performance-wise, signal reception was pretty good, and the battery kept the phone alive for two days.

At Rs 8,905, the L6 hits the sweet spot on the pricing front. If you're on a limited budget and want a stylish phone, the Motorola L6 is perfect.



Company **Motorola India Pvt Ltd**

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Rating 

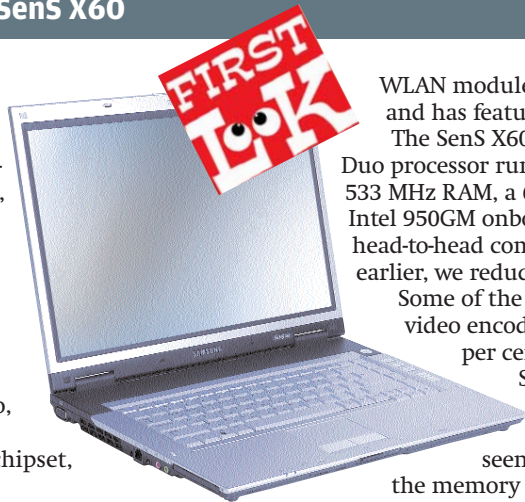
The Napa Platform—Samsung SenS X60

We got a chance to review the Samsung SenS X60, which hasn't yet hit the shelves. It's the first notebook based on Intel's next-gen mobile platform, code-named Napa, which was released in January of this year. We tested the X60 to see whether Napa lives up to its expectations.

The new platform is the third generation of the venerable Centrino platform, which brought about a revolution of sorts in the mobile computing segment. Napa, like Centrino, has three major components—a power-optimised processor, a completely new chipset, and the wireless module.

While Pentium M processors were used in previous versions of the Centrino platform, the Napa platform features the dual-core Yonah processor, officially christened "Intel Core Duo." The processor has 2 MB of cache; however, unlike the desktop dual-core Pentium D with a separate 2 MB cache for each core, this mobile processor uses shared 2 MB for both the cores. This design supposedly improves performance. Also, the FSB has been boosted to 166 MHz, resulting in support for DDR2 667 MHz dual-channel memory. On the clock speed front, these dual-core processors will be available from 1.5 GHz to 2.16 GHz.

On the chipset front, these notebooks will feature the 945GM/PM. The 3945ABG (Golan) is the wireless module that will go in most Napa-based laptops. This is the first Intel



WLAN module to plug into the PCI-Express bus, and has features that improve data throughput.

The SenS X60 is equipped with a T2300 Core Duo processor running at 1.66 GHz, 1 GB of DDR II 533 MHz RAM, a 67 GB, 5400 rpm drive, and the Intel 950GM onboard graphics controller. For a head-to-head comparison with some laptops tested earlier, we reduced the memory to 512 MB.

Some of the test results were astounding: in video encoding, the new processor is nearly 40 per cent faster than the Pentium M!

SiSoft Sandra 2005, too, reported similar results. The scores are much better than what we've seen on Pentium M laptops—ditto for the memory bandwidth benchmark. When

multitasking, the Core Duo processor outshines single-core based notebooks by a wide margin.

You'd expect that the dual-core processor would suck the juice out of the battery, but the fact is the battery life is about the same as that of most Pentium M laptops.

The Napa platform delivers what it was designed for—performance, while not being a power hog. If you're planning on buying a new notebook, we'd definitely suggest you wait and opt for the new platform, rather than investing in an older Pentium M laptop. The Samsung SenS X60 will be available in few months; Napa-based models from other manufacturers will soon pour in.

Rating 